

requirement of a username and password. It is a simple procedure. When the user is prompted to enter the username and password, it checks the pair entered against the ones in a secure file. If there is a match found, the user is allowed further access. Authorization allows the user to enlist those people who are authorized to obtain the information that is stored on the cloud. In corporations, due to the hierarchy in place, different employees might be allowed different levels of access to the data on the cloud. For example, a low-level employee who delivers mail might have very limited access to the data on the cloud whereas the head of the division will have extensive access to information.

Though there exist extensive measures of security, concerns still loom large over cloud storage systems. While you can access data on the go without relying on hardware, it is now theoretically available to the world. Testament to this cause for concern is the increasing number of attacks by anonymous hackers on unsuspecting victims, often having their social network accounts wiped out or their passwords changed. This being the least of the violations that one could face, what if sensitive information such as credit card details, passport number, pan card number, etc. stored on the cloud are traced by a hacker? Personal measures can be taken to avoid such a grave situation by changing one's username and password regularly and storing such sensitive information in a secure location, physically, and not on the web.

Google recently eased a lot of nerves by declaring that it now encrypts all data before copying to disk. Thus, all your data is being decrypted on the fly when it is read by you. This means that none of the thousands of employees who man the data centres where your information might be stored are privy to your un-encrypted personal information. The same applies to our Digit Forum, for example: while an administrator can change your password and block your account, he can never know what your password was, which is an ideal form of security, because say, if you use the same password as your email account, no forum admin can ever know what that password is, as it is stored encrypted in the database from the moment you enter it.



Outsourced storage performance is obviously lower than local storage. How much slower depends on the speed of the pipe you're willing to invest in and obviously the higher the bandwidth, the better the experience, but it can never be as good as a local hard drive.